

ADHD CLEANING & HOME MANAGEMENT PLANNER

No Shame, Just Systems

Neurodivergent-Friendly Cleaning Schedules

Room-by-Room Checklists | Habit Stacking

5-Minute Resets | 30-Day Tracker

Daniel Tesfamariam

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WHY CLEANING IS HARD WITH ADHD

If your house is messy, it's NOT because you're lazy. Here's why ADHD makes cleaning genuinely harder:

Executive Dysfunction:	Can't START tasks even when you want to
Object Permanence:	If you can't see it, it doesn't exist (including messes)
Time Blindness:	'I'll do it later' becomes never
All-or-Nothing:	If you can't deep clean, you do nothing
Overwhelm:	A messy room = 100 tasks your brain can't prioritize
Dopamine:	Cleaning is boring. Your brain needs stimulation.
Perfectionism:	If it won't be PERFECT, why start?

**VALIDATION: Your worth is NOT determined by the state of your home.
You deserve systems that work WITH your brain, not against it.**

THE BODY DOUBLING CONCEPT

Body doubling = having another person present while you do a task.

They don't need to help - just being there activates your brain.

Options for body doubling:

- Have a friend come over (they can bring their own work)
- Video call someone while you both clean
- Watch cleaning YouTube videos
- Listen to podcasts/audiobooks while cleaning
- Join an online body doubling community
- Use apps like Focusmate for virtual accountability

My body doubling plan:

ROOM: KITCHEN

5-MINUTE QUICK CLEAN:

- ☐ Wipe counters
- ☐ Load/unload dishwasher
- ☐ Take out trash
- ☐ Wipe stove top
- ☐ Quick floor sweep

15-MINUTE CLEAN:

- ☐ All of 5-min PLUS:
- ☐ Clean microwave inside
- ☐ Wipe cabinet fronts
- ☐ Organize one drawer
- ☐ Mop floor

DEEP CLEAN (monthly):

- ☐ All of 15-min PLUS:
- ☐ Clean oven
- ☐ Deep clean fridge
- ☐ Scrub sink
- ☐ Organize pantry
- ☐ Clean behind appliances

ROOM: BATHROOM

5-MINUTE QUICK CLEAN:

- ☐ Wipe counter/sink
- ☐ Swish toilet bowl
- ☐ Hang up towels
- ☐ Toss empty bottles
- ☐ Quick mirror wipe

15-MINUTE CLEAN:

- ☐ All of 5-min PLUS:
- ☐ Scrub toilet fully
- ☐ Clean mirror properly
- ☐ Wipe shower walls
- ☐ Empty trash

DEEP CLEAN (monthly):

- ☐ All of 15-min PLUS:
- ☐ Scrub grout
- ☐ Wash bath mats
- ☐ Organize under sink
- ☐ Deep clean shower
- ☐ Replace old products

ROOM: BEDROOM

5-MINUTE QUICK CLEAN:

- ☐ Make bed (just pull up covers!)
- ☐ Pick up floor clothes
- ☐ Clear nightstand
- ☐ Open blinds
- ☐ Quick trash pickup

15-MINUTE CLEAN:

- ☐ All of 5-min PLUS:
- ☐ Put away clean laundry
- ☐ Dust surfaces
- ☐ Organize one drawer
- ☐ Vacuum visible floor

DEEP CLEAN (monthly):

- ☐ All of 15-min PLUS:
- ☐ Wash bedding
- ☐ Dust everything
- ☐ Organize closet section
- ☐ Under-bed cleanup
- ☐ Rotate mattress

ROOM: LIVING ROOM

5-MINUTE QUICK CLEAN:

- ☐ Pick up clutter to one pile
- ☐ Fluff pillows/straighten blankets
- ☐ Clear coffee table
- ☐ Stack remotes together
- ☐ Quick trash sweep

15-MINUTE CLEAN:

- ☐ All of 5-min PLUS:
- ☐ Dust TV/electronics
- ☐ Vacuum/sweep
- ☐ Put away pile from 5-min
- ☐ Wipe surfaces

DEEP CLEAN (monthly):

- ☐ All of 15-min PLUS:
- ☐ Deep vacuum (move furniture)
- ☐ Clean windows
- ☐ Dust shelves/books
- ☐ Organize media
- ☐ Wipe baseboards

ROOM: LAUNDRY

5-MINUTE QUICK CLEAN:

- ☐ Start one load
- ☐ Move clothes to dryer
- ☐ Fold one basket
- ☐ Clear top of machines
- ☐ Sort dirty into piles

15-MINUTE CLEAN:

- ☐ All of 5-min PLUS:
- ☐ Fold AND put away
- ☐ Clean lint trap
- ☐ Wipe machines
- ☐ Sort donate pile

DEEP CLEAN (monthly):

- ☐ All of 15-min PLUS:
- ☐ Run machine cleaner
- ☐ Deep clean behind machines
- ☐ Organize supplies
- ☐ Iron/steam what needs it
- ☐ Season closet rotation

ROOM: HOME OFFICE

5-MINUTE QUICK CLEAN:

- ☐ Clear desk surface
- ☐ File/toss loose papers
- ☐ Push in chair
- ☐ Close browser tabs (jk)
- ☐ Empty desk trash

15-MINUTE CLEAN:

- ☐ All of 5-min PLUS:
- ☐ Organize one drawer
- ☐ Wipe screen/keyboard
- ☐ Sort mail
- ☐ Cable management

DEEP CLEAN (monthly):

- ☐ All of 15-min PLUS:
- ☐ Deep organize files
- ☐ Clean all electronics
- ☐ Shred old documents
- ☐ Reorganize supplies
- ☐ Clean chair/desk thoroughly

ROOM: KIDS ROOM

5-MINUTE QUICK CLEAN:

- ☐ Pick up floor toys into ONE bin
- ☐ Make bed (just covers)
- ☐ Dirty clothes to hamper
- ☐ Clear one surface
- ☐ Quick trash check

15-MINUTE CLEAN:

- ☐ All of 5-min PLUS:
- ☐ Sort toys into proper bins
- ☐ Dust surfaces
- ☐ Vacuum
- ☐ Put away books
- ☐ Check under bed

DEEP CLEAN (monthly):

- ☐ All of 15-min PLUS:
- ☐ Toy purge/donate
- ☐ Wash bedding
- ☐ Organize closet
- ☐ Wipe walls/doors
- ☐ Deep clean play area

ROOM: ENTRYWAY

5-MINUTE QUICK CLEAN:

- ☐ Line up shoes
- ☐ Hang up coats/bags
- ☐ Clear surface clutter
- ☐ Check mail pile
- ☐ Quick floor sweep

15-MINUTE CLEAN:

- ☐ All of 5-min PLUS:
- ☐ Wipe door handles
- ☐ Organize shoe rack
- ☐ Sort mail properly
- ☐ Clean mirror/decor

DEEP CLEAN (monthly):

- ☐ All of 15-min PLUS:
- ☐ Deep mop
- ☐ Clean closet
- ☐ Wash door mat
- ☐ Organize seasonal items
- ☐ Clean light fixtures

WEEKLY CLEANING SCHEDULE (SIMPLIFIED)

ONE focus area per day. That's it. Don't do more unless you WANT to.

MONDAY:	Kitchen (15-min clean)
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TUESDAY:	Bathrooms (15-min clean)
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WEDNESDAY:	Laundry (wash, dry, put away)
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THURSDAY:	Living areas (15-min clean)
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FRIDAY:	Floors (vacuum/sweep/mop main areas)
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SATURDAY:	Catch-up or one deep clean task
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SUNDAY:	REST. You deserve it.
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REMEMBER: Done is better than perfect. A quick wipe beats no wipe.

HABIT STACKING FOR CHORES

Attach a cleaning task to something you ALREADY do:

- While coffee brews -> unload dishwasher
- After using bathroom -> wipe counter
- While brushing teeth -> wipe mirror
- After dinner -> wipe stove and counters
- Before bed -> 5-minute reset in living room
- When laundry buzzes -> immediately switch (don't sit down!)
- After shower -> squeegee walls

MY HABIT STACKS:

When I _____ -> I will _____

When I _____ -> I will _____

When I _____ -> I will _____

When I _____ -> I will _____

When I _____ -> I will _____

DOPAMINE PAIRING IDEAS

Make cleaning less boring by pairing it with something fun:

- Favorite podcast + folding laundry
- Dance music + vacuuming/mopping
- Audiobook + organizing drawers
- Phone call with friend + tidying
- YouTube video + dishes
- True crime podcast + deep cleaning
- Reward after: 15 min clean = 15 min phone/game
- Make it a race: beat the song!

MY DOPAMINE PAIRS:

Chore: _____ + Fun thing: _____

Chore: _____ + Fun thing: _____

Chore: _____ + Fun thing: _____

Chore: _____ + Fun thing: _____

Chore: _____ + Fun thing: _____

MONTHLY MAINTENANCE CHECKLIST

Once a month, pick ONE of these. Not all. ONE.

- ☐ Change/wash bedding (all beds)
- ☐ Deep clean one bathroom
- ☐ Clean refrigerator (toss expired items)
- ☐ Vacuum under furniture
- ☐ Wipe light switches and door handles
- ☐ Clean washing machine
- ☐ Dust ceiling fans/vents
- ☐ Organize one closet/cabinet
- ☐ Clean windows (just the ones you notice)
- ☐ Check/change HVAC filter
- ☐ Declutter one junk drawer
- ☐ Deep clean oven/microwave

EMERGENCY: GUEST COMING IN 20 MINUTES!

Don't panic. Follow this exact order:

Minutes 1-3: Grab a trash bag. Walk through every room. Trash everything obvious.

Minutes 4-7: Grab a laundry basket. Put ALL clutter in it. Shove in closet.

Minutes 8-10: Bathroom: wipe counter, close shower curtain, fresh towel, flush.

Minutes 11-13: Kitchen: load dishes in dishwasher (or hide in oven). Wipe counters.

Minutes 14-16: Living room: fluff pillows, straighten blankets, clear coffee table.

Minutes 17-18: Sweep/Swiffer main floor if visibly dirty.

Minutes 19-20: Light a candle. It fixes EVERYTHING. Breathe. You did it.

REMEMBER: No one is inspecting your baseboards. Relax.

MY CLEANING PLAYLIST

Music makes cleaning 10x easier. Build your ultimate cleaning playlist:

HIGH ENERGY songs (for motivation):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

CHILL/PODCAST options (for mindless tasks):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Tip: Make a '15-minute power clean' playlist that's exactly 15 min.

When the music stops, you stop. No guilt.

30-DAY BUILDING HABITS TRACKER

Track your daily cleaning habits. Check off what you did each day.

Goal: Just do SOMETHING. Even 2 minutes counts.

Day	5-min reset?	What I did	How I feel
1	☐		
2	☐		
3	☐		
4	☐		
5	☐		
6	☐		
7	☐		
8	☐		
9	☐		
10	☐		
11	☐		
12	☐		
13	☐		
14	☐		
15	☐		

30-DAY TRACKER (continued)

Day	5-min reset?	What I did	How I feel
16	☐		
17	☐		
18	☐		
19	☐		
20	☐		
21	☐		
22	☐		
23	☐		
24	☐		
25	☐		
26	☐		
27	☐		
28	☐		
29	☐		
30	☐		

CELEBRATE! You built a habit. What reward do you deserve?
